

TEXT 1

Living in the Future

Our life in the future will be changed forever by multimedia. The way we live, work, and play will be totally different from what it is now. Bert C. Roberts, Jr. states in an article that soon we will probably be answering our televisions and watching our phones! Our interactive TVs will actually be some combination of television, telephone, and computer through which we will have access to shopping, movies and other types of information whenever we want them. (Adaptado de Torres, 2001)

TEXT 2

The first Computers

The first computers were very large and expensive machines. In the 1940s, computers such as the ENIAC were used mainly for military calculations. These machines used thousands of vacuum tubes and consumed a lot of electricity.

Early computers could not store large programs. Programmers had to manually configure the machine for each task. Even simple calculations required a lot of preparation.

Although these computers were slow by today's standards, they were an important step in the development of modern computing.

TEXT 3

The invention of the transistor

In 1947, scientists at Bell Laboratories invented the transistor. This small electronic component replaced vacuum tubes in many computers.

Transistors were smaller, faster, and more reliable. They also used less energy and produced less heat. Because of this invention, computers became smaller and more efficient. The transistor helped start the second generation of computers and made the development of modern electronics possible.

TEXT 4

Personal Computers

In the 1970s and 1980s, computers started to become smaller and more accessible. Companies such as Apple, IBM, and Microsoft played an important role in the development of personal computers.

The IBM PC, released in 1981, became one of the most influential computers in history. Around the same time, Apple introduced computers that used graphical user interfaces. Personal computers allowed people to use computers at home, in schools, and in offices.